RTIM — Responsibility Traceability Integrity Module

OriginID: OOF-OID-AGA-RTIM-2026-06-14-0029
Architecture Ecosystem: Structured Reality Standards™
Architecture Family: Accountability Governance Architecture (AGA™)
Operational Layer: Responsibility Governance Layer
Governed Space: Responsibility Traceability Integrity
Category: Governance & Enforcement
Subcategory: Responsibility Governance
Type: Responsibility Governance Standard Module
Parent Standard: Responsibility Governance Standard (RGS)
Version: 1.0
Status: Canonical · Open Module
Origin Date: 14 June 2026
Compatibility: OOF Methodology OS · Responsibility Governance Standard (RGS) · Relationship Accountability Standard (RAS) · Authority Governance Standard (AGS) · Evidence Accountability Standard (EAS) · INTEGROS® — Integrity Standard
AI-Readable: Yes
Authority: OOF
Protection: MIP — Methodological Intellectual Property
Canonical Language: English (UCL)

Canonical Definition

Responsibility Traceability Integrity Module (RTIM) defines the structural conditions under which responsibility assignments, responsibility transfers, responsibility ownership, responsibility decisions, responsibility fulfillment activities, and responsibility outcomes remain traceable, reconstructable, reviewable, auditable, governable, and operationally valid throughout the responsibility lifecycle.

RTIM governs responsibility traceability.

The module establishes the integrity conditions required to determine who held responsibility, when responsibility existed, how responsibility moved, what actions were performed under responsibility, and whether responsibility obligations were fulfilled.

Module Operational Role

RTIM defines the responsibility-traceability governance layer of RGS.

Its role is to preserve visibility and reconstructability of responsibility throughout governance environments.

Module Operational Space

RTIM governs:

- responsibility traceability
- responsibility reconstruction
- responsibility auditability
- responsibility history
- responsibility ownership history
- responsibility-transfer traceability
- responsibility evidence linkage
- governance traceability

The module applies wherever governance requires reconstruction of responsibility.

Module Function

The module applies wherever systems must preserve:

- traceable responsibility assignments
- reconstructable responsibility history
- auditable responsibility decisions
- accountable responsibility ownership
- governance-valid responsibility records
- operational responsibility transparency

Its function is to ensure that governance can reconstruct and review responsibility throughout the entire operational lifecycle.

Minimum Implementation Framework

1. Define the Responsibility Traceability Object

The organization must define which responsibility environments require traceability governance.

This may include:

- management structures
- contractor chains
- subcontractor environments
- regulatory systems
- operational environments
- quality-control systems
- AI governance systems
- Human-AI operational systems

2. Define Responsibility Traceability Conditions

The system must define the conditions under which responsibility traceability remains valid.

This includes:

- traceability requirements
- reconstruction requirements
- evidence requirements
- accountability requirements
- auditability requirements
- governance-valid traceability conditions

3. Define Traceability Degradation Detection Logic

The system must define how responsibility-traceability failures are identified.

This may include:

- missing responsibility records
- undocumented responsibility transfers
- incomplete responsibility history
- evidence gaps
- governance-blind responsibility assignments
- unreconstructable responsibility chains

4. Define Operational Response or Governance Logic

The system must define governance logic for responsibility-traceability failures.

Governance response may include:

- responsibility review
- audit procedures
- governance intervention
- responsibility reconstruction
- corrective actions
- ownership verification
- operational invalidation where required

5. Preserve Traceability & Restrict Invalid Conditions

The system must preserve reconstructable traceability of:

- responsibility assignments
- responsibility transfers

- responsibility decisions
- evidence records
- governance reviews
- resulting responsibility states

A responsibility-governance environment must not remain traceability-valid if materially significant responsibility activities cannot be reconstructed, reviewed, audited, validated, or governed.

Use Case 1 — Multi-Layer Contractor Chain

Scenario

A client contracts a primary contractor, who hires subcontractors, who assign operational activities to workers across multiple responsibility layers.

Application

RTIM reconstructs the complete responsibility chain and determines where responsibility existed throughout operational execution.

Result

Governance gains visibility into responsibility ownership across the entire contractor structure.

Use Case 2 — Human-AI Operational Environment

Scenario

A human supervisor, orchestration platform, AI agents, and automated systems participate in operational execution involving multiple responsibility assignments.

Application

RTIM reconstructs responsibility ownership, responsibility transfers, and responsibility fulfillment throughout the operational lifecycle.

Result

Governance gains visibility into responsibility pathways across intelligent operational systems.

Canonical Closing Statement

Responsibility Traceability Integrity Module (RTIM) defines the structural conditions under which responsibility assignments, responsibility transfers, responsibility ownership, responsibility decisions, responsibility fulfillment activities, and responsibility outcomes remain traceable, reconstructable, reviewable, auditable, governable, and operationally valid throughout the responsibility lifecycle.

Responsibility that cannot be reconstructed cannot be governed. Responsibility traceability integrity therefore becomes a foundational condition of trustworthy responsibility governance.

Related Documents

→ Responsibility Governance Standard - (RGS)

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Canonical Source

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